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Cursor 3 💻, Gemma 4 🔬, Codex pay-as-you-go 💸

1 message

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Together With CDATA

TLDR AI 2026-04-03

MCP Integration Architecture, Not Just the Model, Determines AI Accuracy (Sponsor)

We benchmarked five MCP integration approaches—native vendor servers, iPaaS, Unified API, MCP Gateways, and CData Connect AI—against 378 real-world prompts spanning CRM, project management, cloud data warehouse, and ERP systems.

The key finding: most approaches fail silently, dropping filters, misreading schemas, or breaking on multi-step logic. The accuracy gap? **25 percentage points.**

That's a gap that compounds fast, at 75% per-step accuracy across a 5-step workflow, fewer than 24% of processes complete correctly.

CData Connect AI achieved 98.5% accuracy across testing. Read on for the full results and testing approach.

Read on for more

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Headlines & Launches

Cursor 3 (5 minute read)

Cursor released a redesigned interface focused on agent-driven development, enabling multi-repo workflows, clearer abstraction, and coordination between local and cloud agents.

Qwen3.6-Plus: Towards Real World Agents (31 minute read)

Qwen3.6-Plus perceives the world with greater accuracy and sharper multimodal reasoning than previous models. It offers a highly stable and reliable foundation for the developer ecosystem and delivers a truly transformative 'vibe coding' experience. The model marks a critical milestone in the journey toward native multimodal agents. The Qwen team plans to release open-source, smaller-scale variants of the model in the coming days.

Gemma 4 Open Models (5 minute read)

Google DeepMind introduced Gemma 4, a new generation of open models optimized for reasoning and agent workflows, offering high performance per parameter under an Apache 2.0 license.

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Deep Dives & Analysis

Q1 2026 Timelines Update (4 minute read)

Progress in agentic coding has been faster than expected over the past three to five months. Coding agents have exploded in usefulness and popularity. Some AI company researchers say that automated AI R&D is coming soon. This moves previous predictions about AI forward.

Open Models have crossed a threshold (6 minute read)

Open models are now a viable alternative to frontier models for core agent tasks like fill operations, tool use, and instruction following. GLM-5 and MiniMax M2.7 each score similarly to closed frontier tasks at a fraction of the cost and latency. They offer a level of consistency and predictability that makes real-world workflows much more viable.

Engram Memory System Deep Dive (12 minute read)

Weaviate detailed Engram, a memory system built on vector search, showing how persistent context improves agent workflows while highlighting challenges in reliable tool usage.

Straight lines on graphs (6 minute read)

Many people are skeptical of data that shows that progress in AI is rapid and remarkably regular over time. Most people eventually realize that these 'straight lines on graphs' actually represent reality. This post shares some of the mental models that result from finally accepting the pace of AI progress.

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Engineering & Research

Turn any knowledge base into a battle-ready MCP server (Sponsor)

Scroll.ai equips your agents with deep domain understanding - improving accuracy, latency, and cost by up to 5x compared to RAG-based approaches. Easily ingest docs, spreadsheets, slides, and audio files from dozens of systems.

Get your first month free ($200 value) with code TLDR-2026

New ways to balance cost and reliability in the Gemini API (2 minute read)

Google has added two new service tiers to the Gemini API that give users granular control over cost and reliability. Flex Inference is a new cost-optimized tier designed for latency-tolerant workloads without the overhead of batch processing. The Priority Inference tier offers the highest level of assurance at a premium price point to help ensure users' most important traffic isn't preempted, even during peak platform usage. The new tiers eliminate the complexity of async job management while giving users the economic and performance benefits of specialized tiers.

ClawKeeper Agent Security Framework (GitHub Repo)

ClawKeeper provides a real-time security framework for autonomous agents, combining instruction-level safeguards, runtime enforcement, and independent monitoring.

Multimodal Coding Agents Benchmark (GitHub Repo)

Vision2Web is a benchmark for evaluating multimodal agents on end-to-end website development tasks across the full software lifecycle.

Miscellaneous

Why it's getting harder to measure AI performance (9 minute read)

The METR group's data suggests that API progress is moving at an exponential rate. Some models achieve scores above the previous trend line, suggesting very rapid progress indeed. However, despite ability, task lengths still vary significantly, making METR's measurements difficult to use as a comparison of progress. While newer models appear to be better than previous ones, it is hard to say how much better they are.

My self-sovereign/local/private/secure LLM setup, April 2026 (25 minute read)

AI can actually create a future with much stronger privacy and security, if done well. Locally-generated code can replace the need for downloading complicated external libraries, allowing software to be minimalistic and self-contained. Removing the browser means that entire classes of user fingerprinting attacks can be eliminated overnight. Dark UX patterns would no longer work, and scams would be more identifiable. This future will require more people to contribute to building secure, open-source, local, privacy-friendly AI tooling that is safe for the user and leaves the control and power in users' hands.

Today we're announcing 3 new world class MAI models, available in Foundry (2 minute read)

Microsoft is launching three MAI models, available on Foundry, that outperform competitors in speed, quality, and efficiency. MAI-Transcribe-1 starts at $0.36 per hour, while MAI-Voice-1 and MAI-Image-2 are also priced competitively. These models are designed for human-centric AI and come with integrated safety features for secure deployment.

Quick Links

Is Claude Code 5x Cheaper Than Cursor? (27 minute read)

The choice isn't just 'cheaper vs more expensive', it's what kind of capacity is required.

Codex Flexible Pricing for Teams (2 minute read)

OpenAI introduced pay-as-you-go pricing for Codex, allowing teams to scale usage based on tokens while lowering entry costs and simplifying cost tracking.

Meta tests Paricado model family, also Health agents (3 minute read)

Avocado's Mango and 9B variants are in testing, showcasing improved multimodal capabilities over Llama 4.

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